

GROWING FORWARD CO. | FREE GUIDE

The 90-Day Financial Clarity Reset

How to regain control of your money and your mind.

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Always Be Growing Forward

INTRODUCTION

Financial Chaos Creates Mental Chaos.

There's a specific kind of tired that comes from never feeling caught up financially.

It's not just about the numbers. It's the mental weight of constantly reacting — checking your account before every purchase, watching your paycheck disappear before the week is out, making minimum payments and wondering if anything is ever actually moving.

Most people living in financial stress aren't careless. They're overwhelmed. There's a difference.

"I realized I didn't just need more money. I needed a system."

Money stress creates mental clutter. When your finances feel out of control, it bleeds into everything else — your focus, your mood, your relationships, your ability to think clearly about the future.

The good news? Clarity is the first step toward control. You don't need to be perfect. You don't need to have it all figured out. You just need a starting point.

This guide is that starting point. Over the next 90 days, you'll move through four phases designed to bring clarity, stability, strategy, and momentum to your finances — one step at a time.

Progress over perfection. Always.

The Financial Fog.

Before we talk about solutions, let's talk about what you might be experiencing right now. Because if any of these sound familiar, you're not broken — you just don't have a system yet.

You might be in the Financial Fog if:

- Money seems to disappear and you're not sure where it went
- You feel anxious checking your bank account
- You're making minimum payments but balances barely move
- You get paid and feel okay, then feel broke a week later
- You've tried budgeting before but it never sticks
- Financial conversations feel stressful or overwhelming
- You're not sure exactly how much debt you have

Sound familiar? That's the Financial Fog. It's not a character flaw. It's what happens when life gets busy and no one ever taught us how to actually manage money in a practical, real-world way.

The fog lifts when you stop reacting and start building a system. That's exactly what the next 90 days are designed to do.

"You're not bad with money. You just haven't had a system yet."

Phase 1: Awareness.

Goal: Understand where your money is actually going.

You can't fix what you can't see. The first phase of this reset is purely about awareness — no changes, no restrictions, just honest observation.

Most people are shocked by what they find in this phase. Not because they've done anything wrong, but because small expenses add up in ways we never track mentally.

Your Phase 1 Action Steps:

1

Download your last 2–3 months of bank statements.

Don't judge what you find — just look. This is information, not a report card.

2

List every recurring expense.

Subscriptions, memberships, auto-pays, insurance, utilities. Write them all down.

3

Identify your financial leaks.

A financial leak is any spending that doesn't align with what you actually want. It could be unused subscriptions, impulse purchases, or forgotten charges that quietly drain your account every month.

Common financial leaks to look for:

- Subscription services you forgot you signed up for
- Apps with free trials that converted to paid
- Impulse purchases under \$20 that add up quickly
- Fees — overdraft, late, annual card fees
- Duplicate services (two streaming platforms for the same content)

"Awareness doesn't fix everything. But it removes the fog — and that changes everything."

Phase 2: Stabilization.

Goal: Build your Financial Command Center.

Now that you know where your money is going, it's time to build the system that puts you in control of it. Think of this as your Financial Command Center — a simple, organized place where your money makes sense.

This doesn't need to be complicated. A basic spreadsheet is enough to start. The goal is to create a structure so money flows through a system instead of disappearing into the void.

Your Financial Command Center includes:

- A simple list of all income sources and amounts
- Every fixed expense (same amount every month)
- Every variable expense (amount changes month to month)
- A paycheck tracking section — what comes in, what goes out
- A running total of remaining balance after expenses

Once this system exists, you'll stop guessing. You'll know exactly what's committed before your paycheck hits, and you'll see your surplus clearly — which is the fuel for the next phases.

The shift from reactive to intentional is one of the biggest mental wins in this process. When money has a destination before it arrives, the anxiety around it starts to shrink.

"A system doesn't restrict your money. It gives it direction."

The Paycheck Cycle.

Why monthly budgets often fail — and what works better.

Most traditional budgeting advice tells you to budget monthly. The problem? Most people don't get paid monthly. They get paid weekly or biweekly — and that disconnect is why so many monthly budgets fall apart.

Paycheck cycle budgeting solves this by organizing your finances around how money actually enters your life, not around a calendar.

The Paycheck Cycle:

→ Paycheck Arrives

Your income lands. This is the start of the cycle.

→ Expenses Are Assigned

Before spending anything, assign every committed expense to this paycheck.

→ Surplus Is Identified

Whatever remains after expenses is your surplus. This is what you work with.

→ Surplus Is Allocated

Your surplus gets distributed intentionally — not spent randomly.

This system eliminates the mid-month broke feeling. When you know exactly what's committed and what's available, you stop flying blind.

The paycheck cycle isn't about restriction. It's about awareness before spending instead of regret after spending.

"Know where your money is going before it gets there."

Phase 3: Strategy.

Goal: Give every dollar a mission.

By now you have clarity and a system. Phase 3 is where you start making intentional decisions about where your money goes — especially your surplus.

This phase focuses on one of the biggest quiet drains in most people's finances: high-interest debt and the minimum payment trap.

Understanding the Minimum Payment Trap:

Minimum payments are designed to keep you paying as long as possible. On a \$5,000 credit card balance at 22% interest, making only minimum payments could take over 15 years to pay off — and cost you thousands in interest alone.

The fix isn't complicated. It's intentional. Any extra money you can direct toward high-interest debt accelerates your progress dramatically.

Phase 3 Strategy Steps:

- List all debts with balances and interest rates
- Identify which debt has the highest interest rate
- Direct surplus toward that debt first (while maintaining minimums on others)
- When that debt is gone, roll that payment toward the next one
- This is called the debt avalanche — and it saves the most money over time

Every dollar you put toward high-interest debt is a dollar that stops working against you. That shift in momentum builds faster than most people expect.

"Every dollar should have a mission. Even the small ones."

THE METHOD

The 60 / 30 / 10 Rule.

A simple allocation rule for your surplus money.

Once you've identified your monthly surplus — the money left after all committed expenses — this simple split gives it direction.

Important: this rule applies to your surplus only, not your entire paycheck.

60%

Debt Reduction

Direct the majority of surplus toward your highest-interest debt. This accelerates payoff and reduces the amount of interest you pay over time.

30%

Savings or Move Fund

Build your emergency fund, a savings goal, or a financial buffer. This is your stability layer — the cushion that keeps one unexpected expense from derailing everything.

10%

Buffer

Keep a small percentage flexible. Life happens. Having a built-in buffer prevents you from blowing the entire system when something unplanned comes up.

As your debt decreases, you can adjust these percentages to shift more toward savings and future goals. The method evolves with your progress.

"Simple systems beat complicated ones every time."

Phase 4: Momentum.

Goal: Recognize and accelerate your turning points.

Something interesting happens around week 10. If you've followed the system, you'll start to see results. Maybe a debt got paid off. Maybe your savings hit a milestone you haven't seen in years. Maybe you just feel less anxious when you check your account.

These are financial turning points — and they're more powerful than they look.

What Turning Points Look Like:

- A car loan gets paid off — that monthly payment becomes available surplus
- A credit card balance hits zero — minimum payment freed up for savings or debt
- An unexpected expense gets handled without going into debt — system working
- Additional income appears — a side project, a raise, a tax refund
- Your emergency fund hits one full month of expenses

The key is to be ready for these moments before they arrive. When that car loan is gone, don't absorb that payment back into random spending. Redirect it. That's how financial acceleration happens.

Momentum in finances works just like momentum in anything else — small wins compound. One paid-off debt makes the next one easier. One saved emergency fund changes how you respond to life.

"Momentum isn't an accident. It's what happens when a system meets consistency."

The Calm Money Loop.

A simple, repeatable system you can run for the rest of your life.

By the end of 90 days, you're not just managing money better — you're running a system that works on autopilot. Here's what that loop looks like:

Paycheck Arrives

Income enters the system.

→ Expenses Are Assigned

Fixed and variable expenses are covered first.

→ Surplus Is Identified

What's left is yours to direct.

→ 60/30/10 Is Applied

Surplus splits into debt, savings, and buffer.

→ Repeat

Next paycheck, same system. Consistency creates momentum.

The Calm Money Loop isn't exciting. That's the point. Financial stress comes from chaos. Financial calm comes from consistency.

Once the loop is running, you stop dreading your bank account. You stop feeling behind. You start feeling like someone who has a handle on things — because you do.

"Consistency creates momentum. Momentum creates freedom."

The Shift Nobody Talks About.

Here's something the financial industry doesn't talk about enough: fixing your finances fixes your head.

When money is chaotic, your mind is chaotic. You make decisions from a place of scarcity and stress. You avoid looking at numbers because they feel threatening. You stay in reaction mode because you don't have a plan.

But when a system exists — even a simple one — something shifts.

What changes when the system is running:

- Financial anxiety decreases because uncertainty decreases
- Decision-making improves because you're not operating from fear
- You start thinking about the future instead of just surviving the present
- Money conversations feel less threatening
- You start believing that progress is actually possible

This is why the Growing Forward philosophy connects money, mindset, and motivation. They are not separate things. Financial systems reduce anxiety. Reduced anxiety creates mental space. Mental space creates better decisions. Better decisions create growth.

Discipline creates freedom. Not just financial freedom — mental freedom.

"You don't just want more money. You want less weight. A system gives you both."

CLOSING

Keep Moving Forward.

90 days from now, you will not be the same person financially — if you actually do the work.

Not because some magic formula fixed everything. But because you chose awareness over avoidance. You chose a system over chaos. You chose to grow forward instead of staying stuck.

Financial clarity is not about being rich. It's about being in control. Knowing where your money goes. Having a plan. Feeling like the person managing your finances — not the person being managed by them.

The Growing Forward philosophy has always been this: progress over perfection. One step at a time. Not perfectly. Not all at once. Just forward.

You don't need to have it all figured out today. You just need to take the next right step.

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If you found this guide helpful and want to talk through your financial picture — visit growingforwardco.com. No pressure. Just clarity.

BONUS

Your 90-Day Financial Reset Checklist.

Use this checklist to track your progress through the reset. Check each item off as you complete it.

PHASE 1 — AWARENESS (Weeks 1–3)

- Downloaded last 2–3 months of bank statements
- Listed all recurring monthly expenses
- Identified financial leaks (unused subscriptions, forgotten charges)
- Cancelled or reduced at least one financial leak
- Completed a full picture of where money has been going

PHASE 2 — STABILIZATION (Weeks 4–6)

- Built my Financial Command Center (spreadsheet or tracker)
- Categorized all expenses (fixed vs. variable)
- Set up paycheck cycle tracking
- Identified my monthly surplus after all expenses
- Stopped reacting to money and started directing it

PHASE 3 — STRATEGY (Weeks 7–9)

- Listed all debts with balances and interest rates
- Identified highest-interest debt to target first
- Applied the 60/30/10 method to my surplus
- Made at least one extra payment toward high-interest debt
- Every dollar in my surplus has a mission

PHASE 4 — MOMENTUM (Weeks 10–12)

- Recognized at least one financial turning point

- Redirected freed-up payments toward next financial goal
- Emergency fund has at least \$500 (or 1 month of expenses)
- The Calm Money Loop is running consistently
- I feel more in control of my finances than I did 90 days ago

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